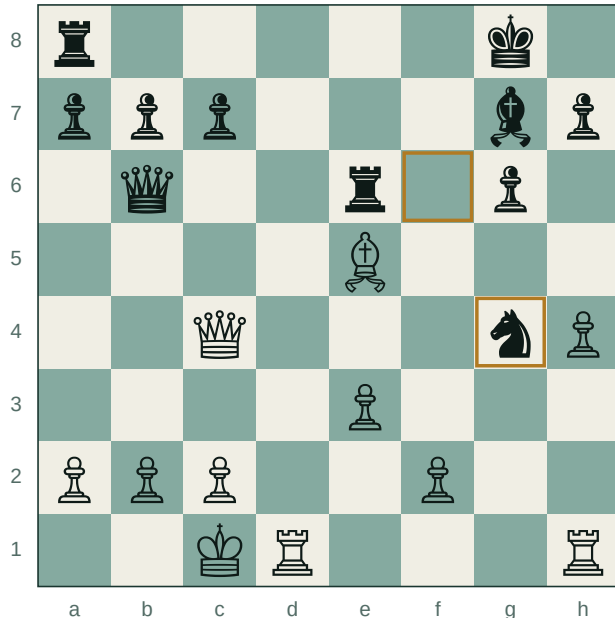


Interference tactics: White, move 21

Interference tactics

White to move



Previous move: 20...Nxg4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21. Rd6 cxd6 22. Qxe6+ Kh8 23. Bxg7+

21.Rd6 The rook moves from d1 to d6. From d6 it attacks queen on b6 and rook on e6. Recorded reply: **21...cxd6**.

22.Qxe6+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on g8 and knight on g4. Recorded reply: **22...Kh8**.

23.Bxg7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the bishop on g7.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: rook on e6.